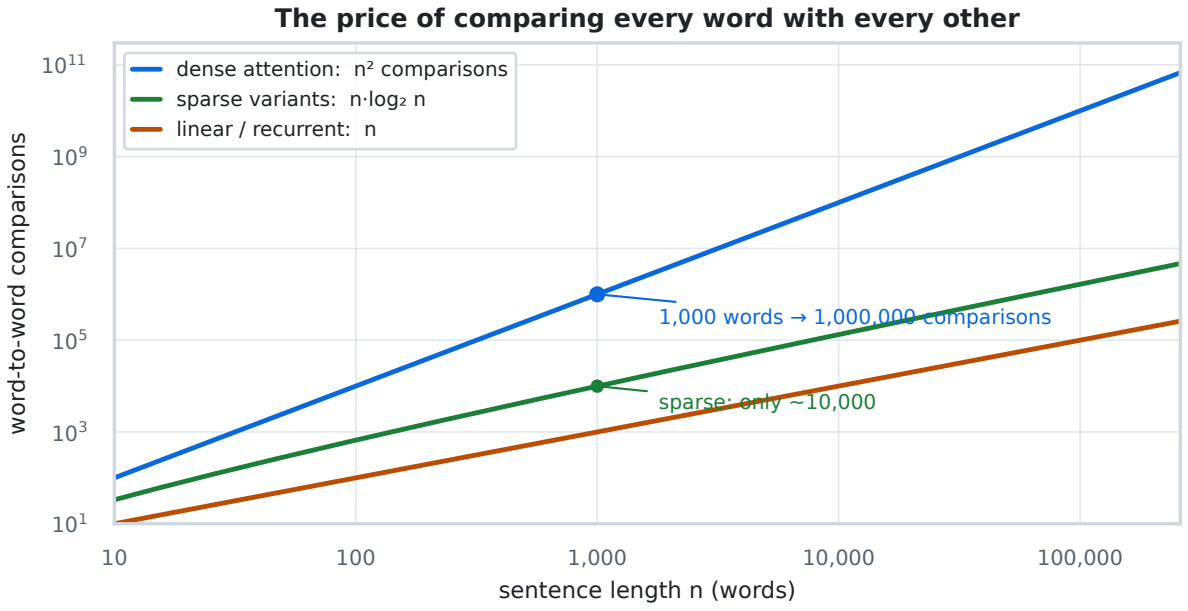
The price of comparing every word with every other
dense attention: n² comparisons
sparse variants: n·log₂ n
linear / recurrent: n
1,000 words → 1,000,000 comparisons
sparse: only ~10,000
word-to-word comparisons
sentence length n (words)
10
100
1,000
10,000
100,000